

Company Pulse: Week 5 Usability Study

Team: _____ Paired team (participants): _____ Date: _____ Facilitator: _____ Note-taker: _____ Recording file: _____

Part 1: Test Script

Before the session (facilitator checklist)

- ☐ Run `./launch_website.sh` and open the "Network" address it prints on the participant's computer.
- ☐ Create two demo members, `demo_alex` and `demo_sam`, each with a short bio.
- ☐ On the facilitator's own laptop, open a **private/incognito window** and log in as `demo_sam`. Keep it ready, but off the participant's screen.
- ☐ Start the recording (QuickTime or Zoom screen recording, with the participant's voice on). Record the screen and audio.
- ☐ Have a .jpg or .png picture ready on the participant's desktop.

Introduction (read aloud)

"Thanks for helping us. Company Pulse is an internal social network for coworkers. We are testing the **website**, not you. There are no wrong answers, and anything confusing is our mistake. Please **think out loud**: say what you are looking at, what you expect to happen, and what surprises you. I will not be able to help during the tasks, but I will answer questions at the end. You can stop at any time. May we record your screen and voice? The recording is only used by our team for this class."

Wait for a verbal "yes" on the recording before you start. Time limit: about 20 minutes.

Tasks (read each one aloud; give no hints)

#	Task given to the participant	Success means	Facilitator notes
1	"You are new to the company. Create an account."	Account created, lands on Log In	Did they notice the username availability message and the hints?
2	"Log in with the account you just made."	Reaches Home	Try an intentional wrong password first, if they do not make a mistake on their own. Note how they react to the error.
3	"Add a short bio and a profile picture about yourself."	Bio and picture saved; green banner seen	Did they find Edit Profile in the menu?
4	"Find the coworker named <code>demo_alex</code> and follow them."	Button changes to Unfollow	Did they use the search box or scroll?
5	"Write a public message to <code>demo_alex</code> ."	Message appears on the page	How did they get to Alex's page?
6	"Now send <code>demo_alex</code> a message that only the two of you can read."	Private whisper sent	Did they understand "Private whisper"?
7	"Find out who follows you and who you follow."	Opens Friends and reads the lists	Did the headings make sense?
8	"Find the message <code>demo_sam</code> sent you and delete it."	Message erased after confirming	Did the Erase confirmation feel clear?
9	"You are finished for the day. Log out."	Logged out, sees confirmation	

Facilitator action after Task 3 (so Tasks 7 and 8 have real data): in the private window, as `demo_sam`, open **Members**, follow the participant's new username, then open their page and send them one public message and one whisper. Do this quietly while they continue, and do not mention it.

If a participant is stuck for more than 2 minutes, say "What would you try next?". If they are still stuck, record "Fail" and move on.

Questions after each task

"On a scale of 1 (very difficult) to 7 (very easy), how easy was that task?"

Final questions (after Task 9)

1. What was the easiest part of the site? What was the most frustrating?
2. Was there any time you were not sure what had happened after you clicked something?
3. Were any words or button labels confusing?
4. On a scale of 1-5, how likely would you be to use this at work? Why?
5. If you could change one thing, what would it be?

Thank the participant and stop the recording.

Part 2: Observation Sheet (fill in during or right after the session)

Task	Done? (Yes / Partly / No)	Time (min:sec)	Ease (1-7)	Errors or hesitations	Quote or observation
1 Sign up					
2 Log in					
3 Profile					
4 Follow					
5 Public message					
6 Whisper					
7 Connections					
8 Erase message					
9 Log out					

Part 3: Summary of Findings

Complete after watching the recording. Delete the instructions in italics.

Participants: ____ people from ____ (role / experience with social sites). **Average ease rating:** ____ / 7. **Tasks completed without help:** ____ of 9.

What works

List 3-4 things, each with evidence from the recording (task number, timestamp, quote). 1. 2. 3.

What needs improvement

List the problems, most serious first. "Severity": High = participant failed or gave up, Medium = slowed down or confused, Low = minor annoyance.

Problem (what happened)	Task / timestamp	Severity	Proposed fix

Participant quotes

| "" (Participant __, Task __)

Next steps

What our team will change first, and who will do it.